



HOANG NGOC DIEU TRAN

Selected works - Landscape  
2026



Hoàng Ngọc Diệu Trân

- [tran.hoangnd.kts@gmail.com](mailto:tran.hoangnd.kts@gmail.com)
- <https://hndt.nl>
- <https://www.linkedin.com/in/tran-hoang>
- +31 634 471 998

## Timeline

July 2025 - present Urban planner  
**FREELANCE - SELF EMPLOYED**

Sep 2023 - July 2025 MSc. Urbanism, Landscape and Planning  
**KU LEUVEN**

Oct 2024 - June 2025 Student job  
**KU LEUVEN**

July 2024 - Aug 2024 Internship  
**METAPOLIS**

Feb 2023 - July 2023 Urban Planner  
**AIM REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT AND DEVELOPMENT JSC - KOG GROUP**

Dec 2019 - Dec 2022 Urban planner  
**SURBANA JURONG - VIET NAM OFFICE**

Aug 2017 - Aug 2019 Urban planner  
**NDA GROUP - NEW DESIGN ASSOCIATES**

Mar 2016 - Feb 2017 Quality controller  
**VIBUMA.COM - VIETNAM BUILDING MATERIALS**

2013 - 2018 BSc. Urban and Regional Planning  
**HO CHI MINH UNIVESITY OF ARCHITECTURE**

## Skills

|                     |                   |            |                      |
|---------------------|-------------------|------------|----------------------|
| Autodesk AutoCAD    | Adobe Photoshop   | Lumion     | Microsoft Word       |
| Autodesk InfraWorks | Adobe Illustrator | QGIS       | Microsoft Excel      |
| Autodesk Civil 3D   | Adobe Indesign    | Handsketch | Microsoft PowerPoint |
| Sketchup            |                   |            |                      |

## Languages

|            |         |       |          |          |
|------------|---------|-------|----------|----------|
| Vietnamese | English | Dutch | Japanese | Mandarin |
|------------|---------|-------|----------|----------|

Whenever I update my portfolio, I feel deeply grateful for the journey I have been on.

As I have grown in my career as an urban planner, I have become more and more drawn to landscape and natural environment. I believe that the development of cities and human settlements should be guided first and foremost by landscape. My aspiration is to explore landscape urbanism more deeply and learn how to design spaces where people and nature can thrive together.



**Selected projects are personal and academic work.**  
**Professional work samples can be shared upon request via presentation or printed book, respecting NDA constraints.**

## Selected works



RECONNECT THE CITY BACK TO WATER  
3



FROM FENCE TO GATHERING  
6



THE ROOT  
8



HEM HEW  
10





## RECONNECT THE CITY BACK TO WATER

Location: Nha Trang, Vietnam  
Student Competition 2025

The site located at the end of the Cai River Basin. This area has lost much of its natural character, as mangroves disappeared and shorelines were simplified. Those are the results by rapid urbanization, mass tourism, and infrastructure development.

The proposal envisions restoring ecological environment of the shores while reconnecting urban life back to nature.

The main strategy is to reintroduce water back to the urban life. By creating a waterfront system with mangroves and dunes, linking parks through landscape corridors, and establishing continuous cycling and pedestrian routes.

1964



1983



2003



2025



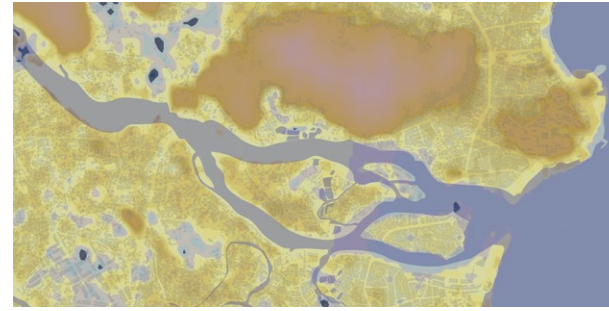
20XX?



Existing urban footprint



Existing green infrastructure

Areas vulnerable to  
alluvial flooding and  
sea-level rise

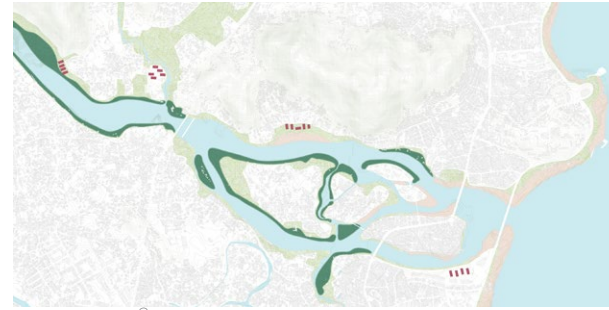
Existing elevation

### Mangroves implementation



### Dunes implementation

Mangroves stabilize the shoreline and prevent erosion. Dune systems - reinforced with local materials and vegetation - protect coasts from seasonal change, creating a balanced and adaptive riverfront landscape.

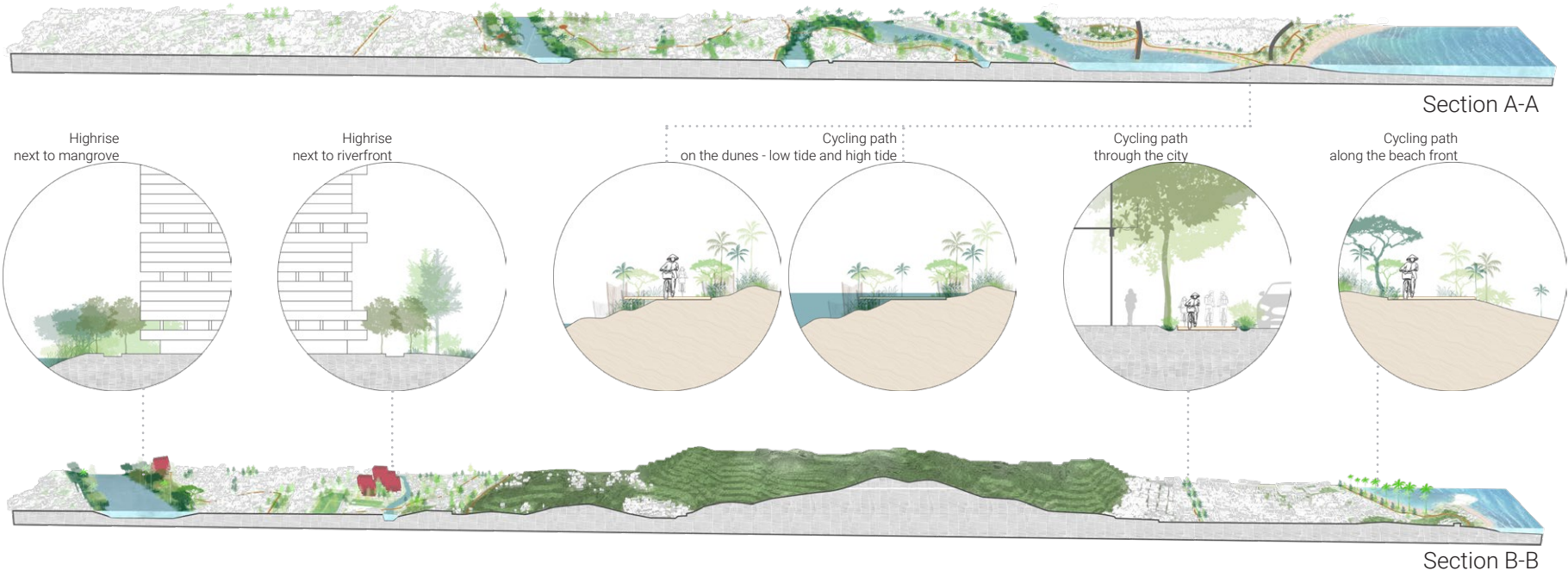


3a



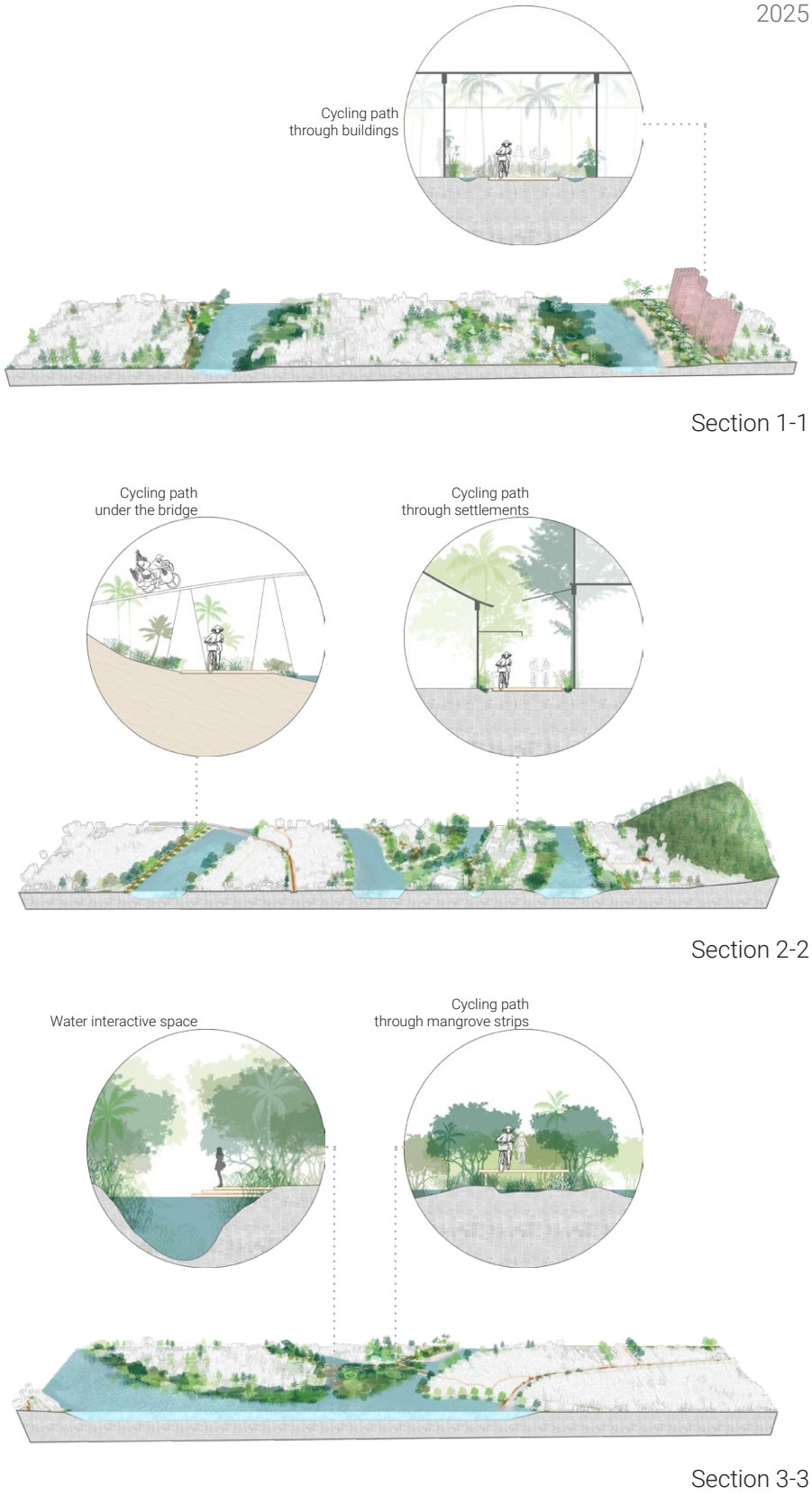
3b





A cycling path system - cycling network - that passes through diverse landscape urbanism spaces while reconnecting tourist and cultural attractions through light mobility

The cycling network weaves through diverse urban landscapes to reconnect cultural and tourist destinations with sustainable, light mobility. Designed around shade, safety, and comfort, its varied typologies create distinct atmospheres while ensuring a cohesive journey. By reducing reliance on large vehicles like tourist buses in dense urban areas, the network fosters a more pedestrian-friendly environment. It welcomes all users: whether local residents, individual backpackers, or large visitor groups, making the city more accessible and enjoyable for everyone.







Exposure of dunes in the dry season and submergence in the rainy season  
View toward the sea

Mangroves and wet parks during dry and rainy season  
View toward the river banks

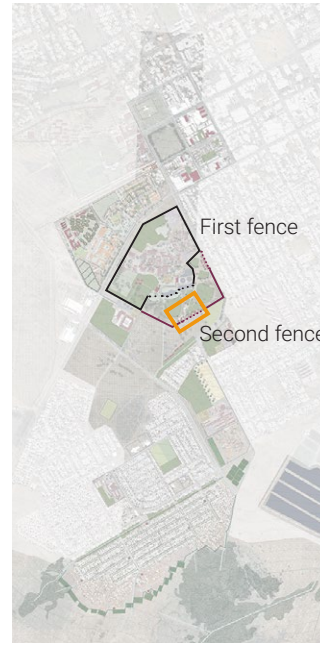




Landscape changes during dry and rainy season



Fences and 'public' facilities



Re-opening the fences



Karoo landscape



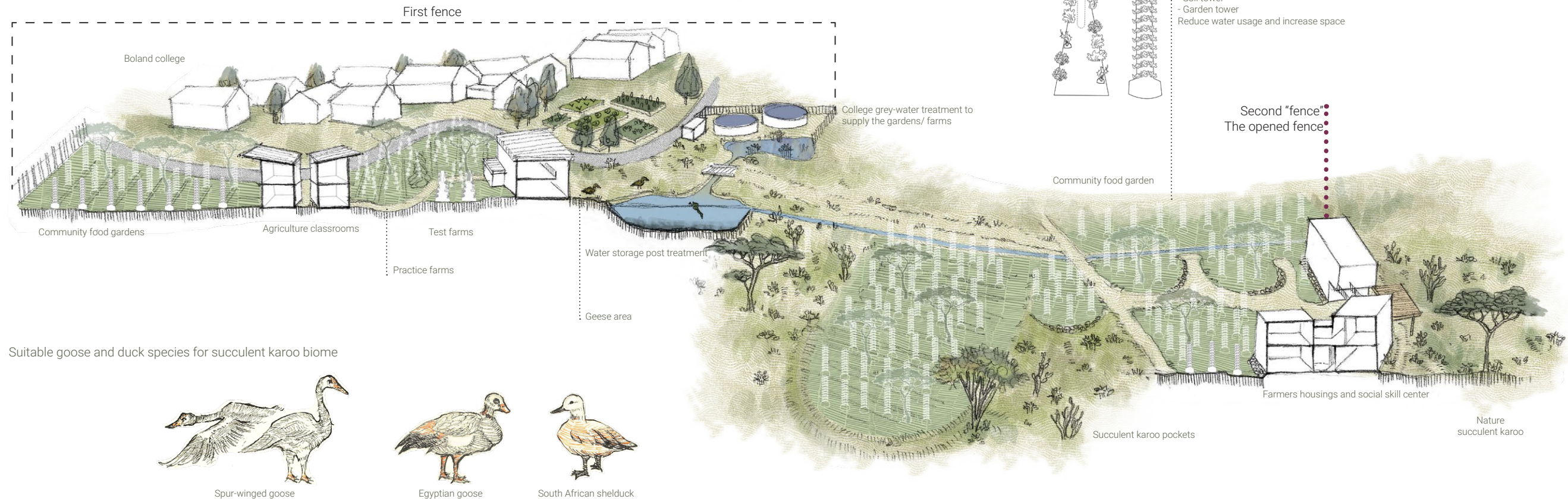
Introduce back Karoo landscape in public space

From Fence to Gathering reimagines the campus edge as a third space, gradually opening the fences to create shared grounds for learning and resilience. Inside the first fence, community gardens connect with Boland College's agriculture programs and test farms, supported by a grey-water treatment system. This system forms water bodies that store rainfall and act as soft ecological boundaries.

## FROM FENCE TO GATHERING

Location: Worcester, South Africa  
Master Studio 2024

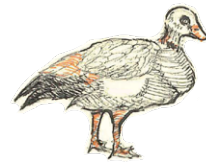
The site is in Worcester Valley, with a semi-arid climate (Karoo). The chosen location is the outer fence of Boland Campus, which contains two colleges currently separated from surrounding neighborhoods by double fencing. The region faces two linked challenges: environmental stress from drought and climate change, and social separation reinforced by fences that isolate schools, health care, and administration from the community. These barriers limit collaboration, resource sharing, and access to opportunities.



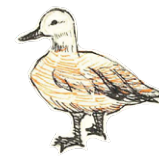
Suitable goose and duck species for succulent Karoo biome



Spur-winged goose



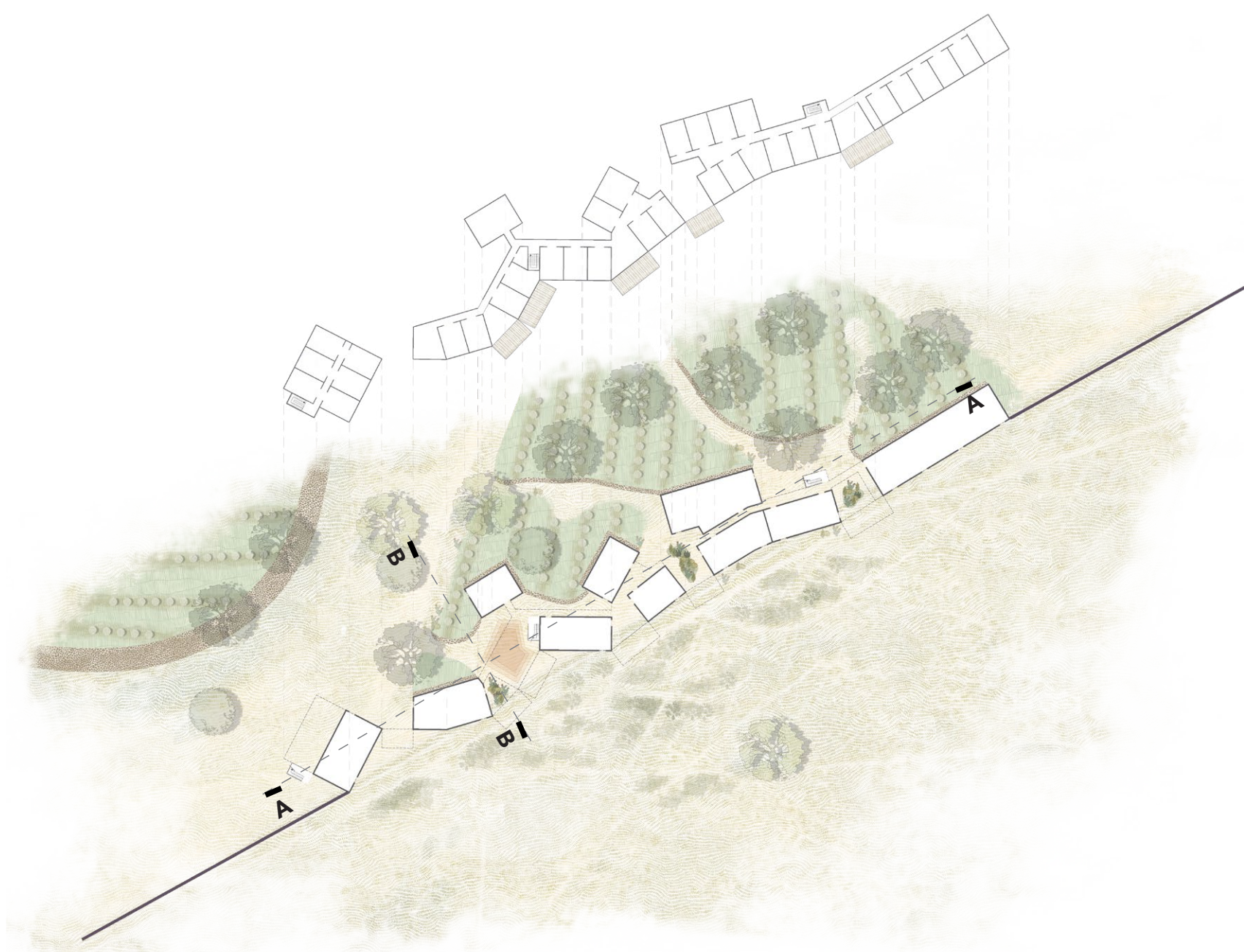
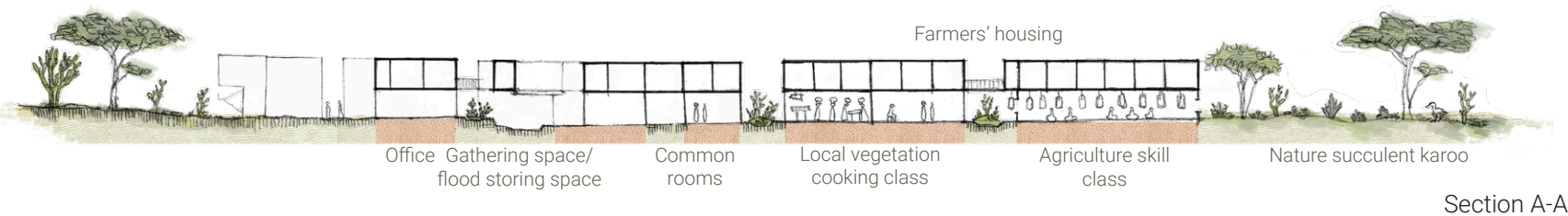
Egyptian goose



South African shelduck

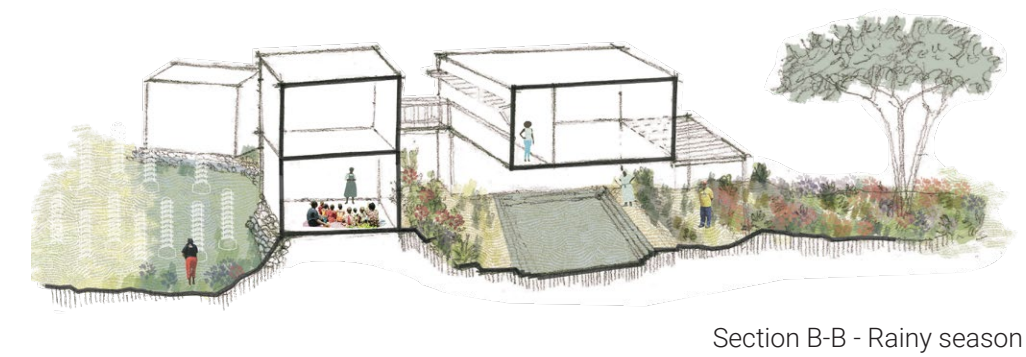
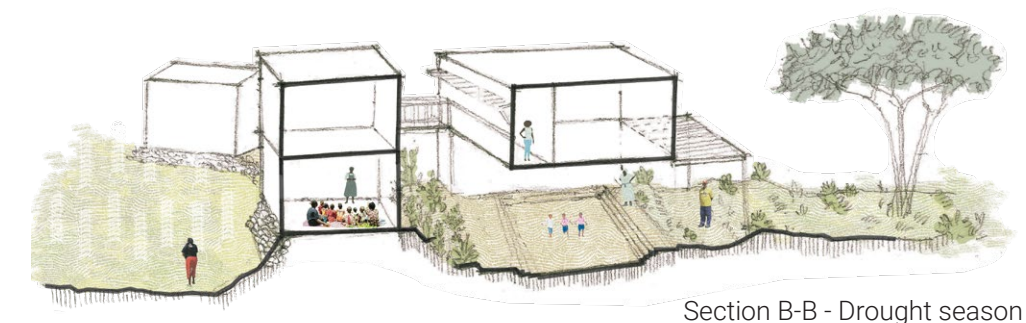
A cut through two fences of the campus





**Reopening the third space  
From fence to gathering**

At the second fence, farmer housing and a social skills center replace barriers with buildings whose ground floors serve as collective spaces for farming, training, and public interaction. Over time, these open spaces dissolve the image of the fence. Rainwater catchments and vertical farming further support sustainable production, transforming separation into connection.



The ground floor open spaces and community gardens could help store floodwater, creating a dynamic atmosphere that changes with the seasons.



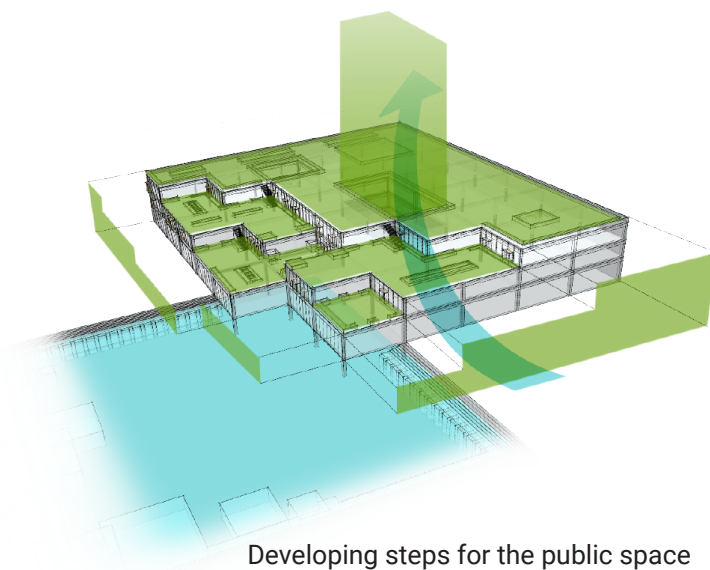
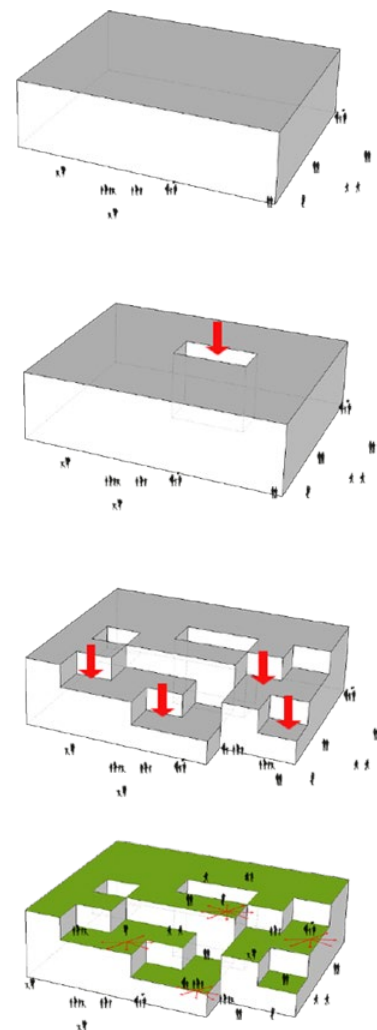


## THE ROOT

Location: Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam  
Student Competition 2018

The vision of the project is to control the expansion of urbanization while increasing water surface areas to store excess rainwater during the wet season for reuse in the dry season. The interventions follow two main approaches:

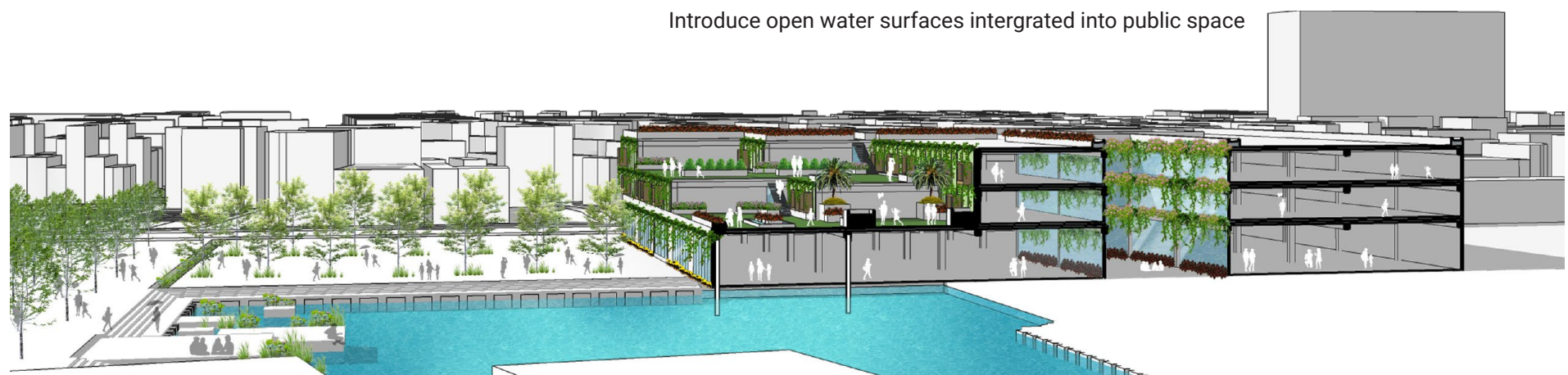
1. A system of open water surfaces integrated into public facilities.
2. A network of open drainage channels or swales, combined with vegetation cover along the network.



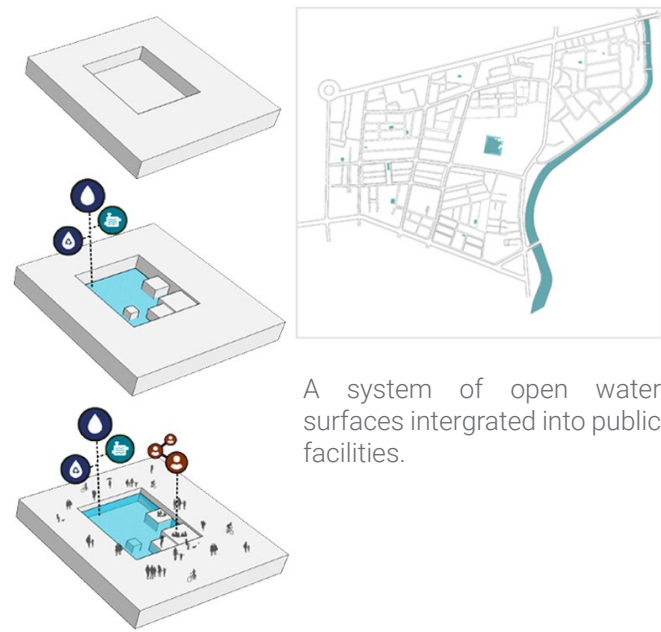
Developing steps for the public space



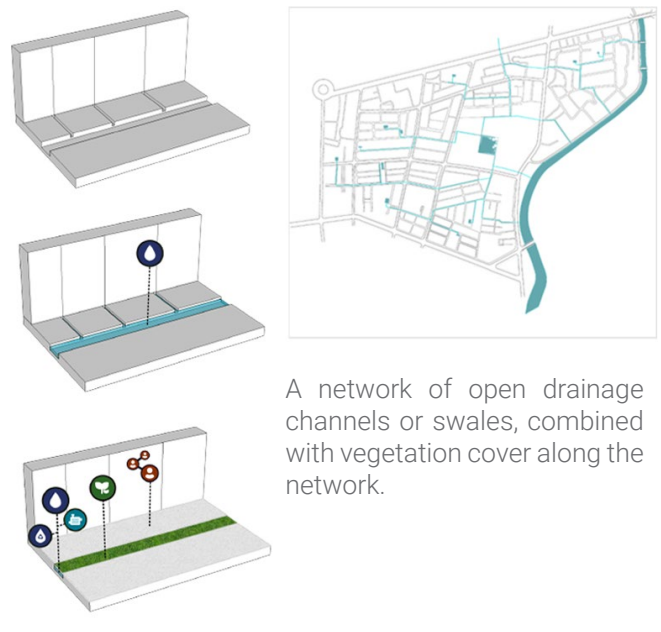
Introduce open water surfaces integrated into public space



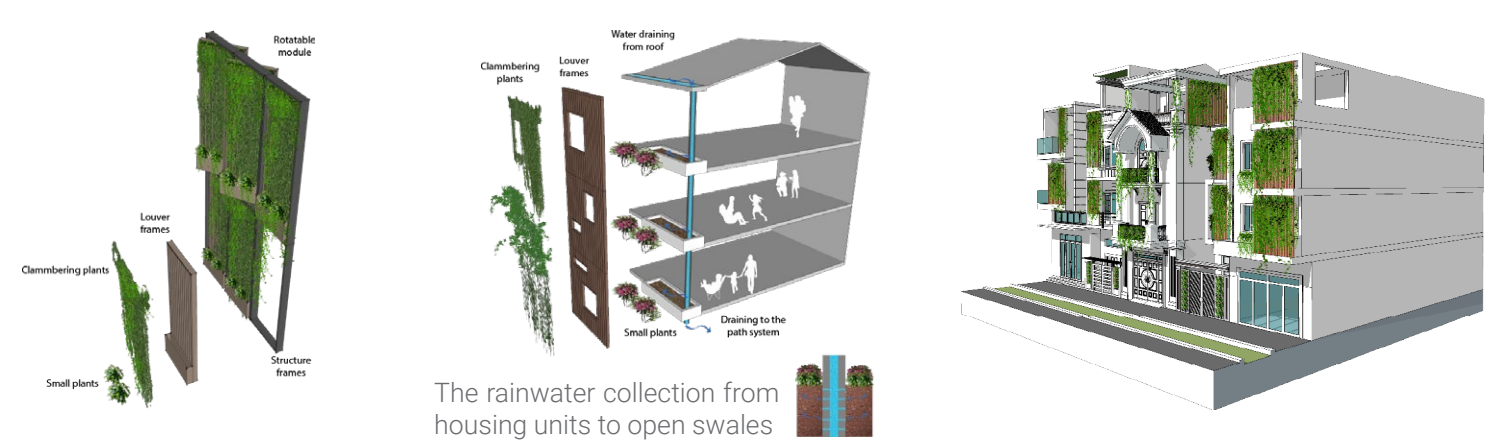




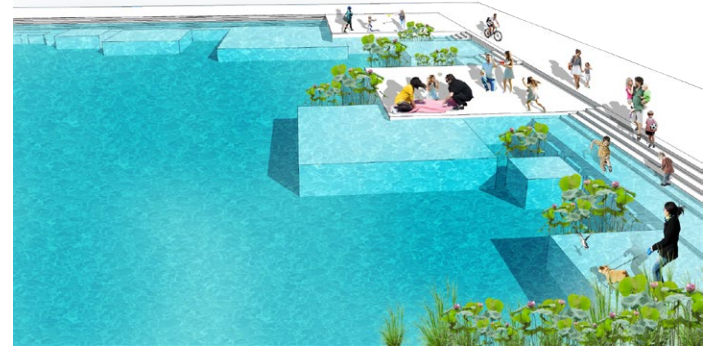
A system of open water surfaces integrated into public facilities.



A network of open drainage channels or swales, combined with vegetation cover along the network.



The rainwater collection from housing units to open swales



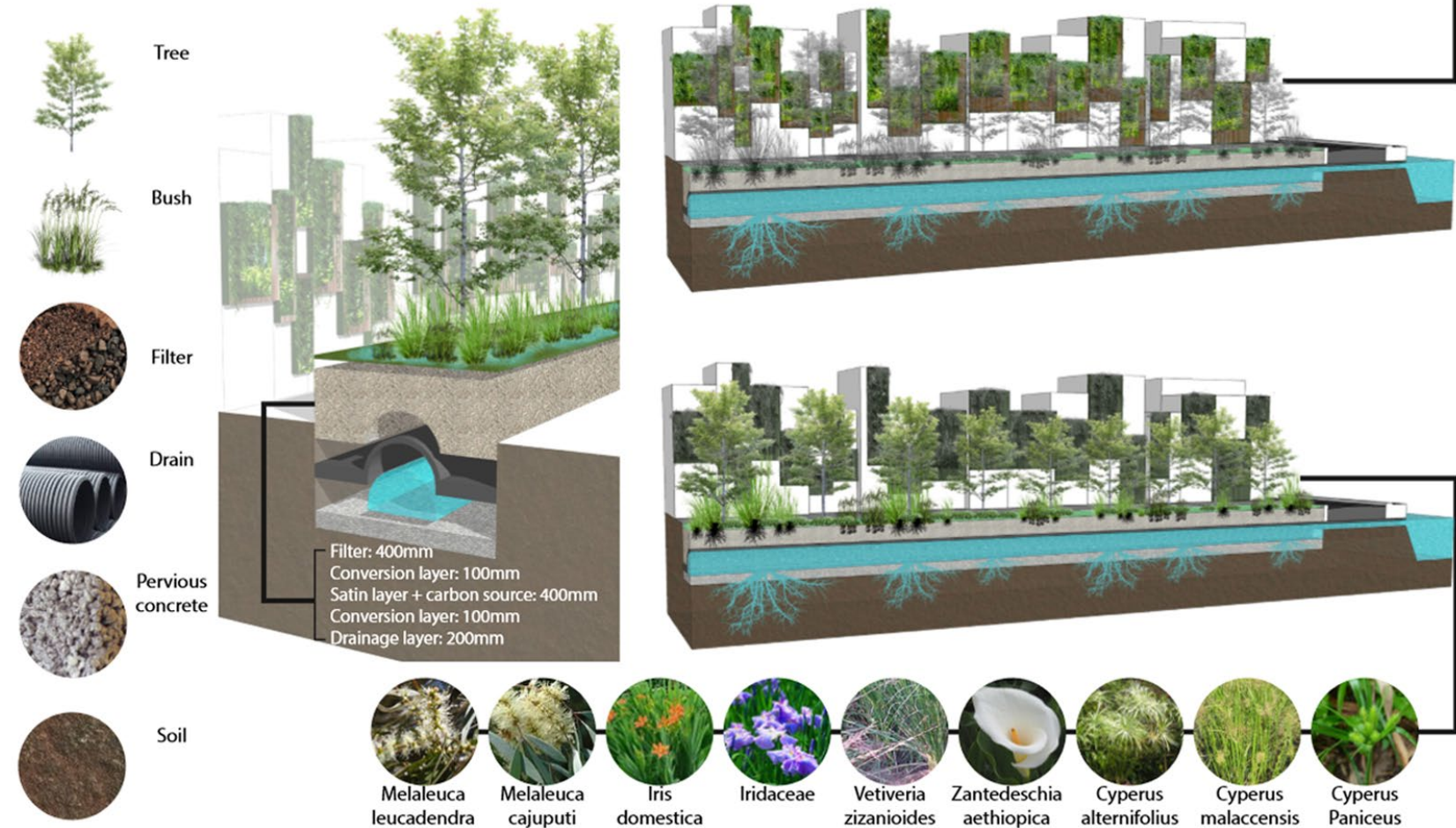
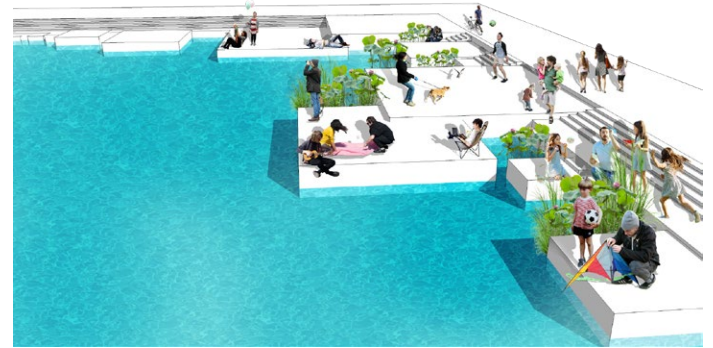
Open water open space for gathering

Wet season



Open drainage swales

Dry season







# HEM HEW

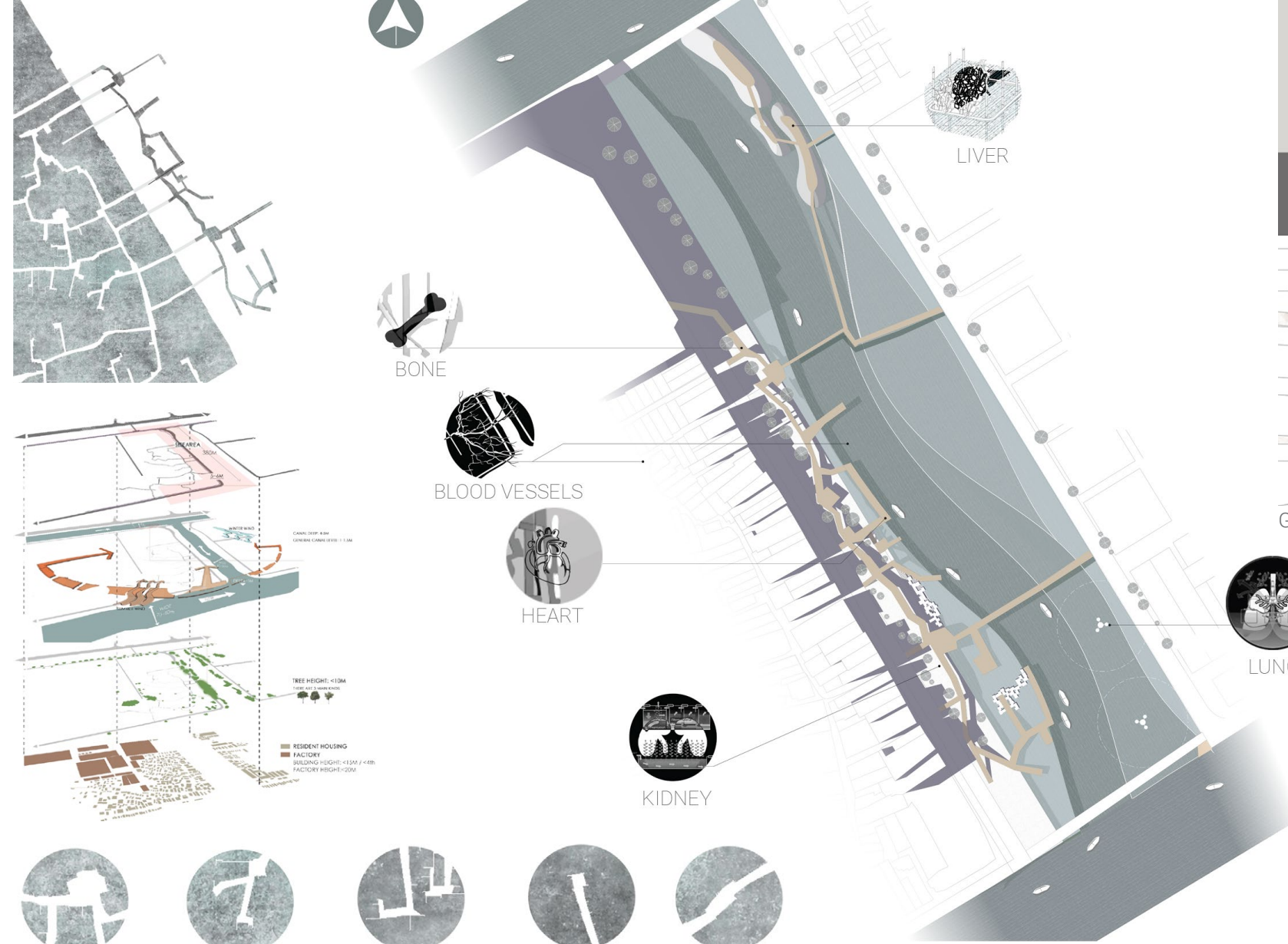
Location: Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam  
Student Workshop 2017

The design vision takes the human body as an ecological metaphor: each design object functions as an organ with a distinct role, while every user acts as a blood cell circulating through and animating the space.

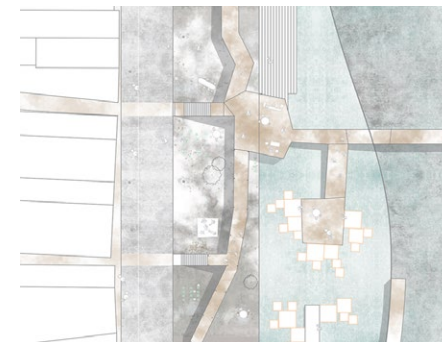
The project also focuses on three key dimensions:

1. Environmental through water filter system on the river.
2. Social through leading the replica of open social spaces within the alleys system.
3. Economy through recycled material for the structures.

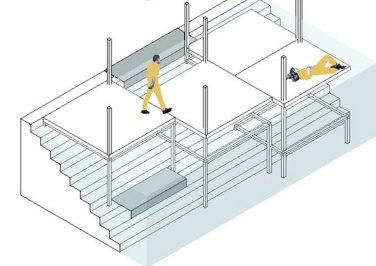
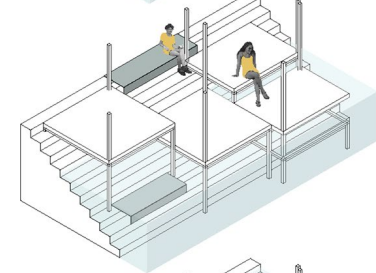
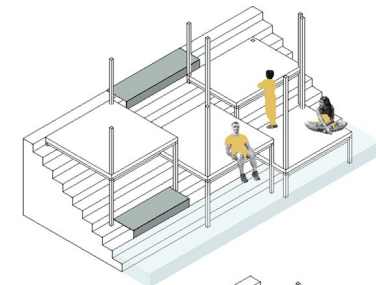
The replica of alleys (Hem) system



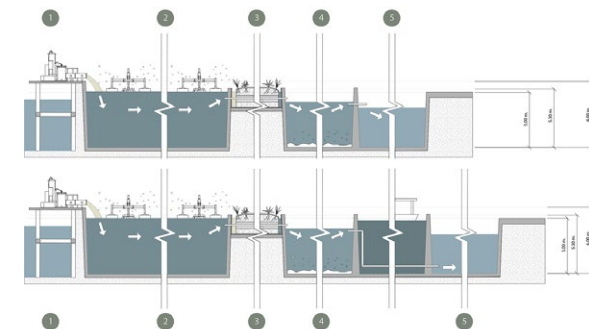
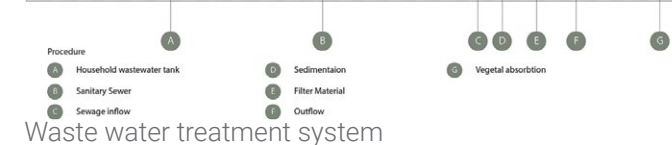
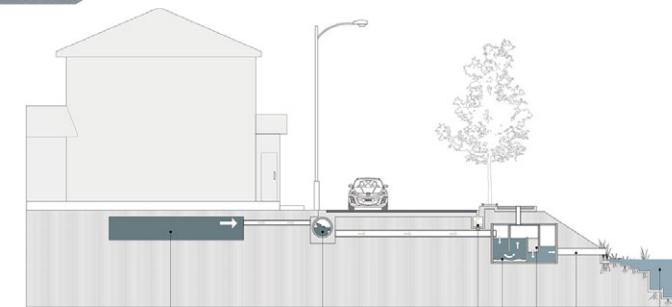
A section through the structures



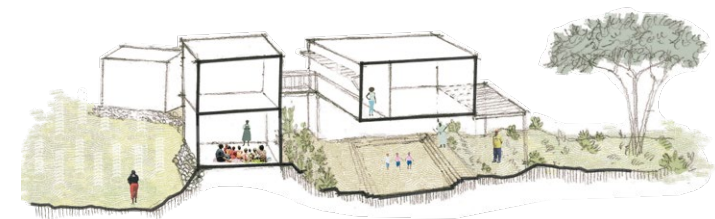
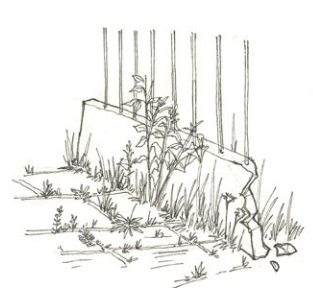
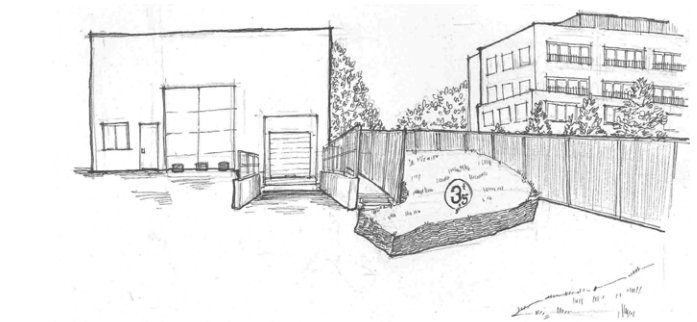
Gathering platforms



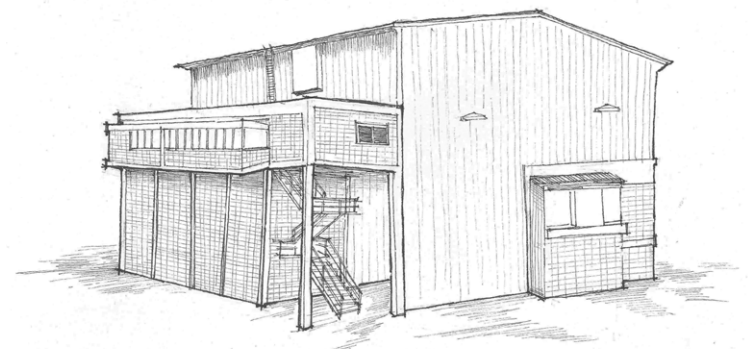
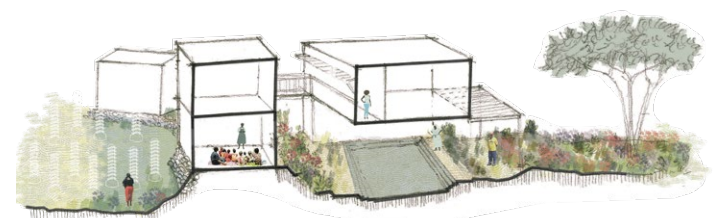
Floating modules moving with the tides







Hand sketching is something I've always loved to do.



Thank you for your time!

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tran.hoangND.kts@gmail.com

